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WHAT IS PEACE?

Peace is a multifaceted concept that encompasses various aspects of human experiences. It literally means the absence of conflicts and presence of positive conditions that promote human as well as societal development. It is a state of being that can be experienced both at the individual as well as societal levels. Peace also involves handling conflicts peacefully, cultivating a virtuous state of mind, and promoting benevolence, confidence, and justice. It is a comprehensive notion that influences quality of life, necessitating collective efforts to promote harmony and well-being. According to United Nations "Peace is the absence of conflict, violence, or hostility, and the presence of justice, equality, and human rights, which creates an environment conducive to human development, well-being, and dignity." The dimensions of peace can be understood through various lenses, but here are some of the most common ones:

- 1. Negative Peace:** This is the most basic level of peace, characterised by the absence of war and direct violence.
- 2. Positive Peace:** This goes beyond the absence of violence and focuses on creating conditions that promote social justice, equity, and well-being.
- 3. Inner Peace:** This refers to a state of tranquility and harmony within oneself.
- 4. Social Harmony:** This refers to the peaceful coexistence of different groups within a society.
- 5. Global Peace:** This refers to the absence of war and conflict between nations.
- 6. Ecological Peace:** This dimension recognizes the dimensions between humans and environment.

It's important to note that these dimensions are interconnected. By understanding and working towards these dimensions, we can create a more peaceful and just world.

FACTORS AFFECTING PEACE

Several factors can influence the presence or absence of peace in a society or globally. Here are some key factors:

Political Factors *

- 1. Good Governance:** Effective and accountable governance, including transparent decision-making, rule of law, and respect for human rights, can foster peace.

2. **Democratic Institutions:** Democratic systems that allow for peaceful transitions of power and representation of diverse interests can contribute to stability.
3. **Conflict Resolution Mechanisms:** Peaceful and fair mechanisms for resolving disputes, such as mediation and negotiation, can prevent conflicts from escalating.

Economic Factors:

1. Reducing economic disparities and ensuring equitable distribution of resources can mitigate social tensions and promote peace.
2. Sustainable economic development that creates jobs and improves living standards can contribute to social stability.
3. International cooperation on economic issues can help prevent conflicts arising from competition for resources.

Social Factors:

Cultural Diversity: Respect for cultural diversity and the promotion of intercultural dialogue can contribute to social harmony.

Social Justice: Addressing issues of social injustice, such as discrimination and inequality, can help prevent social unrest.

Environmental Factors:

1. Resource Scarcity: Competition for scarce resources, such as water and land, can lead to conflict.
2. Environmental Degradation: Environmental degradation can lead to displacement, poverty, and conflict.

It is important to note that these factors are interconnected and can influence each other. Addressing these factors requires a multifaceted approach that involves political, economic, social, psychological, and environmental considerations.

HOW TO INITIATE PEACE ?

Initiating peace is a complex endeavour that requires careful consideration and strategic action. Here are some key steps to consider:

1. Identify the underlying causes of the conflict, whether they are political, economic, social, or cultural.
2. Establish communication channels and mechanisms to facilitate regular exchange.

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* Implement measures to promote social justice, economic development, and political inclusion.

- * Support initiatives that promote social cohesion and unity.
- * Encourage diplomatic efforts and international organizations to contribute to peacebuilding efforts.

Initiating peace is a challenging task that requires patience, perseverance, and a genuine commitment to finding peaceful solutions. By following these steps and working together, it is possible to build a more peaceful and just world.

POSITIVE PEACE

Positive peace , a concept introduced by JOHAN GALTUNG goes beyond the absence of war and focuses on creating societies where people can thrive. It involves fostering positive attitudes like empathy and tolerance, building strong and fair institutions, and establishing equitable structures like healthcare and education. By addressing the root causes of conflict and promoting factors like good governance, free information flow, and positive perceptions of the future, positive peace aims to create lasting peace and well-being for all.

Positive peace is a dynamic and transformative state .It encompasses a comprehensive and sustainable culture of peace, characterised by justice, equality, human rights, and mutual understanding. Positive peace fosters cooperative relationships, inclusive decision-making, and social cohesion, allowing individuals and communities to thrive. It addresses the root causes of conflict, such as poverty, inequality, and environmental degradation, and promotes economic justice, cultural diversity, and sustainable development. By cultivating empathy, tolerance, and respect, positive peace creates a foundation for resilient and harmonious societies, where differences are valued and conflicts are resolved through nonviolent means. Ultimately, positive peace empowers individuals, communities, and nations to reach their full potential, ensuring a brighter future for all.

NEGATIVE PEACE

Negative peace refers to the absence of violence, conflict, or war, but does not necessarily imply a state of harmony, justice, or equality. It is a fragile and superficial calm, often maintained through coercion, repression, or fear.

Negative peace can be achieved through ceasefire agreements, treaties, or other temporary measures that address symptoms rather than root causes of conflict. However, this type of peace can mask underlying tensions, injustices, and

structural issues, potentially leading to future conflicts. In negative peace, human rights may be restricted, social inequality persists, and economic disparities remain unaddressed. The silence is not necessarily a sign of peace, but rather a temporary truce, awaiting the next spark to reignite conflict. Negative peace fails to provide a foundation for sustainable development, social cohesion, or genuine reconciliation, leaving communities vulnerable to renewed violence and instability.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN POSITIVE AND NEGATIVE PEACE

FEATURES	POSITIVE PEACE	NEGATIVE PEACE
DEFINATION	The presence of justice ,equity , and harmony within a society.	The absence of violence and war .
FOCUS	Adresses root causes of conflict.	Focuses on stopping immediate violence.
APPROACH	Proactive and preventive	Reactive and responsive.
OUTCOMES	Sustainable peace and social progress	Temporary cessation of hostilities.

Some examples of positive peace are fair distribution of resources, strong social institutions etc. Some examples of negative peace are ceasefires, peace treaties, disarmament agreement.

COCLUSION

In conclusion, Positive Peace and Negative Peace represent two distinct concepts that shape our understanding of conflict resolution and social harmony. Recognizing the limitations of Negative Peace and striving for Positive Peace is crucial for creating a more just, equitable, and harmonious world, where conflicts are resolved through nonviolent means and diversity is valued.